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Flip through café menus in hipster neighbourhoods or browse through fancy grocery stores, and you are likely to find an abundance of kombucha flavours, making you wonder what this distinctly tart, bubbly beverage is all about. While kombucha is relatively new to India, having been introduced only a few years ago, this sour, slightly effervescent drink, which is a fermented beverage made from tea and sugar, dates back to 220 BC! While the precise origin of kombucha is slightly hazy, the first recipes are believed to have originated during the early Qin Dynasty in China. A couple of centuries later, a Korean doctor reportedly brought the method for kombucha production across the sea to Japan, where he served on the court of Ingyo, Japan's 19th emperor, and lauded the virtues of the drink.